

THE 4602d: THE UNTOLD STORY

By

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On January 3, 1953, Air Defense Command (ADC) Regulation 24-4 created the 4602d Air Intelligence Service Squadron. This special unit had a wartime mission of exploiting downed enemy people, papers, and hardware. Outside of participating in simulated training problems, this unit had no peacetime mission. However, this was to be changed. By the end of 1953, this unit would be doing most, if not all, of the field investigation of UFOB's (UFO Reports), reducing Project Blue Book to nothing more than a information clearing house for the Pentagon.

In Captain (CPT) Edward J. Ruppelt's book, THE REPORT ON UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECTS, on page 303 of the paperback edition, CPT Ruppelt states, "I happened to be expounding my troubles one day (January 24, 1953.ed) at Air Defense Command (ADC) Headquarters while I was briefing General Burgess, ADC's Director of Intelligence, and he told me about his 4602d Air Intelligence Service Squadron (AISS), a specialized intelligence unit that had recently become operational. Maybe it could help-he'd see what he could work out, he told me."

Captain Ruppelt even admits, that in the military it takes time to accomplish various tasks and expressed surprise at the quickness in which General Burgess was able to get the 4602d AISS involved with UFO investigations. Once again, on page 303 CPT Ruppelt states, "But I underestimated the efficiency of the Air Defense Command. Inside of two weeks General Burgess had called General Garland, they'd discussed the problem, and I was back in Colorado Springs setting up a program with Colonel (COL) White's 4602d."

Also, on page 303, CPT Ruppelt states, "The 4602d's primary function is to interrogate captured enemy airmen during wartime; in peacetime all that they can do is participate in simulated problems. Investigating UFO reports would supplement these problems and add a factor of realism that would be invaluable in their training. The 4602d had field teams spread out all over the United States and these teams could travel anywhere by airplane, helicopter, canoe, jeep, or skis on a minute's notice."

With the 4602d now doing most of the field investigation of UFOB's, Project Blue Book confined their activities to,

the Operation Blue Fly Officer to, "insure constant availability of qualified personnel for 'Blue Fly'."

Now one might say that given all this to be true, Project Blue Book would still be charged with the follow-on investigation. Wrong! Remember, that by the end of 1953, Project Blue Book was reduced to, "one officer, one airman, and a secretary operating as the Aerial Phenomena Section of the Electronics Branch, Technical Analysis Division."

I believe that the so-called "Blue Room" really did the follow-on investigation of those reports the ADC could not identify. This would also, explain why many of the cases known to have been investigated by the 4602d did not show up in the Project Blue Book files.

Once Senator Barry Goldwater asked Genral LeMay to see inside of the Blue Room. The general informed the senator that he could not and that the senator was not to bring up the Blue Room ever again. This could explain why.

At present, very little is known of the activities of the 4602d's UFO investigation, Project Moon Dust, Operation Blue Fly, and the so-called Blue Room. However, this much is known; they all dealt in some way with the investigation of reported UFO's. In 1957, they were updated to include, "foreign space debris that survived re-entry into the earth's atmosphere and impacted. Later, after the closure of Project Blue Book, the term "UFO" would be replaced by, "objects of unknown origin."

I have knowledge of the existence of documentation that could prove all that is said above. However, the Air Force, after acknowledging the existence of documents would later attempt to deny their existence to a United States Senator.

Presently, I have an appeal pending with the Air Force for the release of this documentation. I have requested and received the assistance of 3 members of Congress to monitor the out come of this appeal action. The appeal has been on-going for over 5 months now and the Air Force has informed me that it may take another 3 or 4 months before I receive an answer. My basis for this appeal action was that the Air Force stated they had no records, classified or otherwise. Yet, I can prove they have atleast 14 classified records on Moon Dust and Blue Fly. An interesting side note to my appeal, is that first the Air Force lost my appeal. Later, it was found in the classified vault. Does this mean something in my appeal letter is of a classified nature or could it mean that they are considering the release of those records they initially stated did not exist? Only time will tell.

Operation Blue Fly - "to expeditiously retrieve downed Soviet Bloc equipment."

These definitions are only half-true, intended to get the Senator's office off the the Air Force's as_ (case). According to a 1961 Air Force document, the definitions of these missions are:

Project Moon Dust - "As a specialized aspect of its over-all materiel exploitation program, Headquarters, USAF has established Project Moon Dust to locate, recover and deliver descended foreign space vehicles."

Operation Blue Fly - "To facilitate expeditious delivery to FTD of Moon Dust or other items of great technical intelligence interest."

Apparently the Air Force was able to see into the future. It is my understanding the first "space object" did not go into space until October 1957. If this is the case; what was the peacetime missions of Moon Dust and Blue Fly in 1953? Both of these missions were created almost immediately after the 4602d AISS was given the peacetime mission of investigating UFO's in 1953 and were tied directly to the 4602d AISS.

Here is how I believe these missions worked, bypassing Project Blue Book and interfacing with Blue Book only when it became absolutely necessary to do so.

Every Air Force base was required to assign, as an additional duty, a Project Blue Book Officers. His duty was to receive reports on UFO's coming to his attention. Air Force Regulation (AFR) 200-2 required that he report these to the nearest 4602d detachment and not report them directly to Project Blue Book at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base.

The 4602d was required, by AFR 200-2, to make every effort to identify the object(s) in the reports. AFR 200-2 stated, "The Ait Technical Intelligence Center (ATIC), Wright-Patterson Air Froce Base, Ohio, will analyze and evaluate: All information and evidence reported within the ZI after the Air Defense Command has exhausted all efforts to identify the UFOB; and all information and evidence collected in oversea areas." This statement would seem to indicate that if the report could not be identified by the 4602d AISS (ADC), then it was to be forwarded to Project Blue Book at ATIC. However, is wrong. But it is what the Air Force wanted anyone who might see AFR 200-2 to believe.

The 4602d AISS was to forward those cases they could not identify to the Project Moon Dust Monitor Officer, not Project Blue Book. It was this office that was to do the follow-on investigation. Also, if there was a requirement to recover "materiel", this officer would co-ordinate with

the Operation Blue Fly Officer to, "insure constant availability of qualified personnel for 'Blue Fly'."

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